

BETHANY HIGH, SARJAPUR

THE MODEL MILLIONAIRE – NOTES

Section A: Multiple-Choice Questions

1. What made Alan Trevor give Hughie a permanent entrée to his studio?

- (a) His indifference towards the family.
- (b) His pauperism.
- (c) Hughie's spirits and kindness.
- (d) His bright ideas.

Answer: (c) Hughie's spirits and kindness.

2. What was the special feature of the model beggar?

- (a) His patched and cobbled boots.
- (b) His battered hat.
- (c) His torn and tattered clock.
- (d) His piteous expression.

Answer: (d) His piteous expression.

3. What did Hughie do during Trevor's absence?

- (a) He admired Trevor's paintings.
- (b) He smoked a cigarette.
- (c) He gave a sovereign to the beggar.
- (d) He admired the looks of the model.

Answer: (c) He gave a sovereign to the beggar.

4. "What a duffer he must think me!" said Hughie. Why?

- (a) He could not differentiate between a rich man and himself.
- (b) He could not understand Trevor's paintings.
- (c) He gave money to a model thinking him as a beggar.

(d) None of the above.

Answer: (c) He gave money to a model thinking him as a beggar.

5. Why did Hughie think that he should apologise to the Baron?

(a) He felt that he had insulted him.

(b) He felt that he had hurt him.

(c) He felt that he had made a mistake by giving him a sovereign.

(d) He was afraid on knowing that he was Baron.

Answer: (c) He felt that he had made a mistake by giving him a sovereign.

6. "It reflects the highest credit on your philanthropic spirit" is an appreciation from whom and for whom?

(a) Laura Merton for Hughie

(c) Baron Hausberg for Hughie

(b) Alan Trevor for Hughie

(d) Colonel for Laura Merton

Answer: (c) Baron Hausberg for Hughie

7. What does "Millionaire models are rare enough" indicate?

(a) Modelling does not pay well so millionaire models are rare.

(b) Models are always available but are poor.

(c) Models who are millionaires are hardly found.

(d) Models are costly so a model is a millionaire.

Answer: (c) Models who are millionaires are hardly found.

8. Which figure of speech is used in the line:

that old beggar, as you can see him, is one of the richest men in Europe.

(a) Irony

(b) Metaphor

(c) Personification

(d) Simile

Answer: (a) Irony

9. "But what was a butterfly among bulls and bears" means

- (a) Hughie liked butterflies
- (b) Hughie did not fit in at the Stock Exchange
- (c) There were butterflies around bulls and bears
- (d) None of the above

Answer: (b) Hughie did not fit in at the Stock Exchange

10. Which literary device is used in the line:

"Laura adored him and he was ready to kiss her shoe-strings"?

- (a) Imagery
- (b) Metaphor
- (c) Hyperbole
- (d) Irony

Answer: (c) Hyperbole

11. The theme of the story is

- (a) Generosity
- (b) Morality
- (c) Wealth
- (d) All of the above.

Answer: (d) All of the above.

12. Whose point of view is the narrator showing when he says, 'He looked so forlorn'

- (a) Hughie's
- (b) Trevor's
- (c) The audience's
- (d) None of the above

Answer: (a) Hughie's

13. Who is 'he' and whose rags were they in the line "he made a magnificent figure in his rags?"

- (a) Trevor, Hughie's
- (b) Baron, Trevor's
- (c) Hughie, Baron's
- (d) Baron, Baron's

Answer: (d) Baron, Trevor's

14. According to Trevor, where is an artist's heart?

- (a) In his chest
- (b) In his stomach
- (c) In his work
- (d) In his mind

Answer: (c) In his work

Reference to the context:

Passage 1

Unless one is wealthy there is no use in being a charming fellow. Romance is the privilege of the rich, not the profession of the unemployed. The poor should be practical and prosaic. It is better to have a permanent income than to be fascinating. These are the great truths of modern life which Hughie Erskine never realised. Poor Hughie! Intellectually, we must admit, he was not of much importance. He never said a brilliant or even an ill-natured thing in his life. But then he was wonderfully good-looking, with his crisp brown hair, his clear-cut profile, and his grey eyes.

(i) What is said about wealth in the extract? Give the meaning of "The poor should be prosaic".

Answer: The extract suggests that wealth is necessary for romance and charm. It states that romance is a privilege of the rich, not something for the unemployed. The phrase "The poor should be prosaic" means that the poor should focus on practical and realistic matters, rather than indulging in fanciful or romantic ideals.

(ii) Give two positive qualities of Hughie. What was his drawback?

Answer: Hughie was wonderfully good-looking, with crisp brown hair, a clear-cut profile, and grey eyes. He was also popular with both men and women. However, his drawback was that he lacked intellectual significance and never managed to make money.

(iii) What did his father bequeath him? What did he do with his inheritance?

Answer: Hughie's father bequeathed him his cavalry sword and a History of the Peninsular War in fifteen volumes. Hughie hung the sword over his mirror and placed the books on a shelf but did not do anything substantial with these inheritances

(iv) How did Hughie make a living? What was his experience in the Stock Exchange and in other concerns?

Answer: Hughie lived on an allowance of two hundred pounds a year from an old aunt. He tried working on the Stock Exchange for six months but did not succeed. He also briefly worked as a tea merchant and attempted to sell dry sherry, but neither venture worked out for him.

(v) Give the meaning of the following: "Ultimately he became nothing, a delightful ineffectual young man with a perfect profile and no profession."

Answer: This phrase means that Hughie, despite his charm and good looks, ultimately achieved nothing of significance. He remained an attractive, pleasant person but lacked any professional success or clear purpose in life.

Passage 2

To make matters worse, he was in love. The girl he loved was Laura Merton, the daughter of a retired Colonel who had lost his temper and his digestion in India, and had never found either of them again. Laura adored him, and he was ready to kiss her shoe-strings.

(i) Who is he' referred to in the extract? What troubles he had earlier in his life?

Answer: The "he" in the extract refers to Hughie Erskine. Earlier in his life, Hughie faced several troubles, primarily financial instability. Despite being charming and popular, he lacked the ability to make money. He tried different professions, such as working on the Stock Exchange, being a tea-merchant, and selling dry sherry, but none of these ventures succeeded, leaving him with no stable income.

i) Give the meaning of "who had lost his temper and digestion in India." With reference to India, what theme is referred to?

Answer: This phrase refers to Laura Merton's father, the retired Colonel. It suggests that the Colonel's experiences in India, likely due to the stress and challenges of his military service, caused him to become irritable and suffer from health problems, particularly related to his digestion. The theme here reflects the common trope of British officers returning from colonial service in India physically and emotionally worn down by the harsh conditions and the demanding nature of their roles.

(iii) Name and explain the figure of speech used in the following "and he was ready to kiss her shoe- strings."

Answer: The figure of speech used here is hyperbole. It is an exaggeration to emphasize how deeply Hughie loves Laura. The phrase implies that Hughie admires her so much that he would do anything for her, even perform a humble act like kissing her shoe-strings, which is used to express his devotion and adoration.

(iv) They were the handsomest couple in London' but what was lacking in their lives? How did they obtain it?

Answer: What was lacking in their lives was financial stability. Although Hughie and Laura were in love and admired for their looks, they did not have enough money to marry. They obtained the money when Baron Hausberg, a wealthy man whom Hughie had mistakenly given money to, gifted them a cheque for £10,000 as a wedding present.

(v) What was the Colonel's attitude towards Hughie? What does that say about Hughie? Which characteristic trait of the Colonel is reflected in his attitude towards Hughie?

Answer: The Colonel was fond of Hughie but refused to allow his daughter to marry him until Hughie had £10,000. This shows that although Hughie was well-liked, he was seen as financially irresponsible and lacking the means to support a family. The Colonel's attitude reflects his practical and cautious nature, prioritising financial security over emotions in considering marriage for his daughter.

Passage 3

One morning, as he was on his way to Holland Park, where the Mertons lived, he dropped in to see a great friend of his, Alan Trevor. Trevor was a painter. But he was also an artist, and artists are rather rare. Personally he was a strange rough fellow, with a freckled face and a red ragged beard. However, when he took up the brush he was a real master, and his pictures were eagerly sought after.

(i) Who is 'he' referred to in the extract? Where did he go? Why?

Answer: "He" refers to Hughie Erskine. He was on his way to Holland Park, where the Mertons lived, to visit Laura Merton, the woman he loved. Hughie was courting Laura, but her father would only allow their engagement if Hughie could provide £10,000 of his own.

(ii) Describe Alan Trevor's appearance.

Answer: Alan Trevor is described as a strange, rough fellow with a freckled face and a ragged red beard.

(iii) What is said about Trevor as an artist? Why was he attracted by Hughie?

Answer: Trevor was a talented painter, highly sought after for his artwork. He was initially attracted to Hughie because of his good looks and charming personality, which

Trevor found aesthetically pleasing as a painter. However, Trevor also came to like Hughie for his bright, buoyant spirits and generous, reckless nature.

(iv) According to Trevor whom should an artist know?

Answer: According to Trevor, the only people a painter should know are those who are both "bête and beautiful," meaning people who are pleasing to look at and not intellectually demanding to talk to.

(v) Why did Trevor give permanent entry to Hughie to his studio? What does that show about Trevor?

Answer: Trevor gave Hughie permanent entry to his studio because he liked Hughie's charm and personality, both for his good looks and for his bright and generous nature. This shows that Trevor was not only appreciative of beauty but also valued personal qualities like Hughie's vivacity and generosity.

Passage 4

When Hughie came in he found Trevor putting the finishing touches to a wonderful life-size picture of a beggar-man. The beggar himself was standing on a raised platform in a corner of the studio. He was a wizened old man, with a face like wrinkled parchment, and a most piteous expression.

(i) Who was the beggar-man? Describe his appearance at the studio.

Answer: The beggar-man was actually Baron Hausberg, a wealthy man disguised as a beggar for Alan Trevor's painting. At the studio, he appeared as a wizened old man, with a face resembling wrinkled parchment and a pitiable expression. He wore a coarse, tattered brown cloak, patched boots, and held out a battered hat for alms while leaning on a rough stick.

(ii) What was a model paid for a sitting? How much does an artist get for a picture?

Answer: A model was paid one shilling per hour for a sitting. The artist, Alan Trevor, mentioned that he would get two thousand guineas for the picture.

(iii) According to Hughie what must be paid to a model? How is that a comment on Victorian society at that time?

Answer: Hughie believed that the model should receive a percentage of what the artist earned from the picture, as they worked just as hard. This reflects Victorian society's class divide, where manual or less esteemed work, like modeling, was undervalued and poorly compensated compared to the intellectual or artistic work of the wealthy.

(iv) What does Trevor say to imply that artist's work is hard?

Answer: Trevor remarked that "there are moments when Art almost attains to the dignity of manual labour," suggesting that the physical and mental effort required for painting could be just as demanding as manual work.

(v) What is profitable-manual work or intellectual work? Why?

Answer: Intellectual work, such as being an artist, was far more profitable than manual labor. This is evident from the fact that while the model was paid only a shilling per hour, Trevor would receive two thousand guineas for his painting. This reflects the societal value placed on intellectual and creative professions over physical labor during that time.

Passage 5

Don't run away, Hughie," he said, as he went out, I will be back in a moment. The old beggar-man took advantage of Trevor's absence to rest for a moment on a wooden bench that was behind him. He looked so forlorn and wretched that Hughie could not help pitying him.

(i) Why did Hughie pity the beggar-man? What did he do to help him?

Answer: Hughie pitied the beggar-man because he looked forlorn and wretched, with tattered clothes and a miserable expression. To help him, Hughie gave him a sovereign, even though it meant that he would have to go without certain luxuries for a while.

(ii) Which theme prevalent in the Victorian Period is shown in the action of Hughie?

Answer: The theme of charity and social inequality is prevalent in Hughie's action. The Victorian era was marked by significant economic disparity, and Hughie's gesture reflects the era's concerns about the conditions of the poor, even though the beggar was actually a wealthy man in disguise.

(iii) What was the reaction of the beggar-man while receiving alms from Hughie?

Answer: The beggar-man, who was actually Baron Hausberg, started slightly and smiled faintly when he received the sovereign. He thanked Hughie graciously, though his reaction was mild compared to the significance of the gesture.

(iv) State the impact of Hughie's charity.

Answer: Hughie's charity had an unexpected impact: the beggar-man, revealed to be Baron Hausberg, was moved by Hughie's generosity. As a result, Baron Hausberg gave Hughie a cheque for £10,000 as a wedding present, solving Hughie's financial troubles and allowing him to marry Laura.

(v) What was the reaction of Laura and Trevor on Hughie's charity?

Answer: Laura scolded Hughie lightly for his extravagance, though she was unaware of the beggar's true identity. Trevor, on the other hand, found the situation amusing, laughing at Hughie's mistake and later revealing the true identity of the beggar-man.

Passage 6

'Finished and framed, my boy!' answered Trevor, 'and, by the bye, you have made a conquest. That old model you saw is quite devoted to you. I had to tell him all about you who you are, where you live, what your income is, what prospects you have -

(i) What conquest did Hughie make?

Answer: Hughie made a conquest of the old beggar-man, who turned out to be Baron Hausberg. The Baron was very impressed by Hughie's kindness.

(ii) How was the conquest made?

Answer: The conquest was made when Hughie gave a sovereign to the beggar-man, not knowing that the man was actually a wealthy baron in disguise. The Baron's admiration for Hughie's generosity led to this "conquest."

(iii) What was the immediate fear of Hughie when he would go home?

Answer: Hughie's immediate fear when he would go home was that the beggar might be waiting for him, as Trevor had told the beggar all about Hughie's life, including his income and personal details.

(iv) Give the meaning of:

(a) "What you call rags, I call romance. What seems poverty to you is picturesqueness to me"

Answer: This statement reflects the differing perspectives between an artist and a layperson. To Hughie, the beggar's rags symbolize poverty and misery, but to Trevor, the artist, they represent beauty and inspiration, something that adds character and depth to his art.

(b) "An artist's heart is in his head"

Answer: This phrase means that artists are guided by their intellect and creativity rather than their emotions. It suggests that artists may appear detached or unemotional because they prioritize their vision and interpretation of the world over sentimentality.

(v) What was told to the beggar-man about Hughie? What was Hughie's reaction on knowing that Trevor had told the beggar about Hughie and Laura?

Answer: Trevor told the beggar-man all about Hughie, including details of his life, income, and his relationship with Laura. When Hughie found out, he was embarrassed and angry, as he did not expect his private affairs to be shared with a beggar, unaware of the beggar's true identity as a millionaire.

Passage 7

The Baron,' said the old gentleman with a smile, has commissioned me to bring you this letter'; and he extended a sealed envelope. On the outside was written, 'A wedding present to Hugh Erskine and Laura Merton, from an old beggar, and inside was a cheque for £10,000. When they were married Alan Trevor was the best man, and the Baron made a speech at the wedding breakfast. 'Millionaire models, remarked Alan, 'are rare enough; but, by Jove, model millionaires are rarer still!'

(i) Who was the old gentleman who brought the letter? What were the contents in the sealed envelope?

Answer: The old gentleman was a representative of Baron Hausberg, who brought a letter from the Baron. The contents of the sealed envelope included a cheque for £10,000, as a wedding present for Hugh Erskine and Laura Merton from the "old beggar."

(ii) How did the Baron know that Hughie was in need of money? What did he do to fulfil his need?

Answer: The Baron learned about Hughie's financial struggles from Alan Trevor, who had told him about Hughie's personal affairs, including his need for £10,000 to marry Laura. The Baron, who was disguised as the beggar in Trevor's studio, was moved by Hughie's generosity in giving him a sovereign and decided to give him £10,000 as a wedding present.

(iii) What role did Trevor play in finalising Hughie's marriage to Laura?

Answer: Trevor unknowingly played a crucial role by discussing Hughie's financial struggles with Baron Hausberg, who later provided the money Hughie needed to marry Laura. Additionally, Trevor was Hughie's best man at the wedding.

(iv) The story shows that the poor are generous in helping others. How did Hughie's charity to the beggar give him rich dividends?

Answer: Hughie's act of kindness, giving a sovereign to whom he thought was a poor beggar, led to a remarkable outcome. The beggar turned out to be the wealthy Baron Hausberg, who rewarded Hughie's generosity by gifting him a cheque for £10,000, which allowed him to marry Laura.

(v) Explain the meaning of: "Millionaire models are rare enough, but model millionaires are rare still!"

Answer: This remark by Alan Trevor highlights the rarity of wealthy people (millionaires) posing as models, such as Baron Hausberg did. However, it also suggests that it is even more uncommon to find millionaires who are as kind and generous as the Baron, who not only posed as a model but also helped Hughie with a generous gift.